



COMP 440 001
College of Engineering
Department of Computer Science
Fall 2026 Course Syllabus
Game Design

NOTE: Students are responsible for reading, understanding, and following the syllabus.

Course Information

Class Location: MCNAI 214

Meeting Times: 1600-1650 MWF

Instructor Contact Information

Shondale Rhodes

Email: sarhodes@ncat.edu

Office Location: M-Eric 322

Office Phone: (336) 285-2446

Communication

Email will be answered within 3 business days. Emails are to be used for supporting documentation only (example doctors note, OARS, University Travel). If you have an urgent question, come to office hours.

Email is for general questions. **Urgent or grading questions require you make an appointment/meet in person.**

No unsolicited assignments will be accepted through email. All assignments must be submitted on Blackboard or instructed 3rd Party applications.

Email Etiquette

Send all class related email to sarhodes@ncat.edu. "Comp 440" and your section number should be in the subject line when you email me. Without this, you risk your email not being responded to. As new students and many sections of different classes, stating the class and section number in all communications helps ensure faster response times.

Email should start:

Professor Rhodes

My name is (insert your name), a student in (insert your course ID and section).

Example:

Professor Rhodes.

My name is John Doe, I am a student in your Comp440 section 1 course.

Student Hours

MW 11:30am - 12:50pm

Th 11:00am - 3pm

By Appointment

Course Prerequisites

Prerequisites: COMP285

Course Description

This course will provide an introduction to current techniques used in game design. Topics will include game engines, game mechanics, autonomous game agents, and multi-player games. Prerequisites: COMP 285. (F;S;SS)

Student Learning Objectives/Outcomes (SLO)

Upon the completion of this course:

1. Develop game design vocabulary for talking about games and their play
2. Put into practice the basic tools of game design.
3. Understand the demands gameplay makes on players
4. Experience the iterative game design process.
5. Develop critical thinking skills related to the analysis of games and play

Required Textbooks and Materials

Generative AI Tool

Grading Scale

Course Grading Scale

Letter Grade	Numerical
A	90 and above
A-	86-89

Letter Grade	Numerical
B+	82-85
B	78-81
B-	75-77
C+	72-74
C	69-71
C-	66-68
D+	63-65
D	60-62
F	0-59

Grading Allocation

Grading Allocation	
Type	Percentage
Participation/Classwork	20%
Homework	20%
Project	60%
Total	100

Use Of Canvas as The Learning Management System

Canvas is the primary online instructional and course communications platform. Students can access the course syllabus, assignments, grades, and learner support resources. Students are encouraged to protect their login credentials, complete a Canvas training, and log in daily to the course.

Make-Up Exams

No Make-Up Exams

Extra Credit

Extra credit assignments are posted in the "Extra Credit" section

Late Work

- NO LATE WORK ACCEPTED.

- Work sent via email without explicit instructor permission automatically receives a grade of 0
- Expect minimal if any assistance to be provided on due dates - most deadlines fall on weekends when instructors/TAs are unavailable
- No exceptions.

Special Assignments

N/A

AI Course Policy

Use of GenAI (Generative AI)

AI tools are becoming a regular part of our learning experience. To help students understand how to use them effectively and responsibly, these are the different categories of AI tool usage in this course.

- Category 1: Free Use you're encouraged to use AI tools as you see fit. Whether you're doing research, brainstorming ideas, or creating drafts, AI can be a valuable tool.
- Category 2: Limited Use AI tool usage is limited to specific situations. Your instructor will provide clear guidelines on when and how to use these tools.
- Category 3: No Use AI tools are not allowed at all. Using AI in these courses can result in consequences, including a zero on the assignment or further disciplinary action.

All submitted work is subject to an oral examination by the professor or TAs. If a student cannot explain the submitted work significant points will be deducted and/or disciplinary action pursued.

The goal of this course is NOT for students to provide perfectly working code and answers that GenAI can provide from prompts.

1. If a student cannot explain submitted work, a grade of 0 will result

2. If AI is used outside of the designated category of use (e.g. GenAI is used on an Exam, Category 3: No Use) a grade of 0 will result.
3. If a student cannot explain submitted work or AI used outside of the designated category of use on more than 1 occasion a grade of 0 for the course will result along with escalation to administration.

AI Course Guidance

Permitted for Some Activities with Attribution: The use of large language model and other generative AI technologies, including those such as ChatGPT, is allowed only for specified activities or assignments, but proper attribution is required. Students should clearly indicate when AI-generated content has been used and cite the specific language model and platform employed following the citation guidelines specified by APA, MLA, or any other relevant academic style. However, the majority of the work must still be the original creation of the student. Possible disciplinary action for violations of this course policy is described in the university's Academic Dishonesty Policy.

Additional Course Information

Attendance Is Mandatory

Attendance will be marked within the first 10 mins of class. If you miss when attendance is taken, you will be marked absent. If you are not in attendance, the classwork that day will receive a 0 for the grade. This is a fast pace class.

Along with the academic dishonesty policy below, it also includes:

- Providing attendance, quiz or exam codes.
- Use / possession of any unauthorized material, electronic or otherwise, during an exam or quiz.
- Unauthorized use of AI

Active participation is crucial. This includes:

- Engaging in class discussions
- Asking and answering questions during lectures
- Utilizing professor and TA office hours
- Contributing to class activities

Students who do not participate actively should not expect any additional considerations or flexibility in grading matters.

Grade Disputes:

Check your grades regularly (at least twice a week). All grade disputes must be done within 7 days of the posting of the grade. Come to TA office hours and give your reason for the dispute. If not resolved, come to my office hours. ("I think I deserve a better grade", "I think I did better", "The TA does not like me", these are not valid reasons to regrade an assignment.). After the 7-day period, the grade will stand as final.

University Policies

Aggies-Care Link

<https://www.ncat.edu/coronavirus/aggies-care/index.php>

AI Ethical Use First Steps: The following language is intended to guide the use of AI in teaching and learning.

When incorporating ChatGPT or any other generative artificial intelligence (AI) technology into course materials, assignments, or discussions, faculty members at the university should promote ethical use of these tools. This includes providing proper attribution when AI-generated content is used or presented. Citations should follow the guidelines specified by academic writing styles such as APA, IEEE, MLA, or other relevant citation styles. Here's an example from APA:

<https://apastyle.apa.org/blog/how-to-cite-chatgpt>

While faculty members may not be able to always individually verify the originality of all student work in both teaching and research settings, they can play a crucial role with respect to educating student about the importance of originality in their work and upholding university values related to academic integrity. Faculty members are encouraged to explore alternative assessment approaches and technology tools that promote academic integrity and facilitate the identification of AI-generated content when necessary.

It is essential for faculty members and students to be aware of the licensing agreements and terms of service associated with the use of AI language models like ChatGPT or other generative AI technologies. Different language models may have varying usage restrictions, and compliance with ethical and legal guidelines is crucial. Faculty members are encouraged to refer to official documentation provided by the language model's developers, such as OpenAI's website, and any relevant platform-specific guidelines with respect to language model or other generative AI technologies, such as for ChatGPT usage. Standards specific to the dissemination of scholarly products in various venues are likewise essential (conferences, journals, etc).

Guidance for the syllabus:

Regarding language model and other generative AI technologies, including those such as ChatGPT, and their relationship to teaching and learning, the policy in the syllabus should be explicitly stated with reference to the university [Academic Dishonesty Policy](#). Faculty members have the flexibility to choose from the following options if relevant to their course of instruction:

- **Not Permitted:** Assistance from large language model and other generative AI technologies, including those such as ChatGPT, is not allowed for any activities or assignments. All submissions must be the original work of the student, and the use of AI-generated content is strictly prohibited. Possible disciplinary action for violations of this course policy is described in the university's Academic Dishonesty Policy.
- **Permitted for Some Activities with Attribution:** The use of large language model and other generative AI technologies, including those such as ChatGPT, is allowed only for specified activities or assignments, but proper attribution is required. Students should clearly indicate when AI-generated content has been used and cite the specific language model and platform employed following the citation guidelines specified by APA, MLA, or any other relevant academic style. However, the majority of the work must still be the original creation of the student. Possible disciplinary action for violations of this course policy is described in the university's Academic Dishonesty Policy.

Permitted for All Activities with Attribution: The use of large language model and other generative AI technologies, including those such as ChatGPT, is permitted for all activities and assignments, but proper attribution is required. Students should acknowledge the use of AI-generated content and provide appropriate citations following the guidelines specified by APA, MLA, or any other relevant academic style. It is important to emphasize that even with AI assistance, students are expected to engage critically and creatively with the material to produce their work. Possible

disciplinary action for violations of this course policy is described in the university's Academic Dishonesty Policy.

Participation

Students are expected to attend class and participate on a regular basis in order to successfully achieve course learning outcomes and meet federal financial aid requirements ([34 CFR 668.22](#)). Active participation may consist of course interactions with the content, classmates, and/or the instructor. Examples of academically-related course activities include, but are not limited to:

- Completing and submitting assignments, quizzes, exams, and other activities within Canvas or through Canvas (3rd-party products).
- Participating in course-related synchronous online chats, discussions, or meeting platforms such as Zoom in which participation is tracked.

Note: Uploading assignments through Canvas presents a challenge for Chromebook users in locating the files for submission. If you use a Chromebook, please be sure you also have access to a Mac computer or Windows computer so you can fully participate in your Canvas class. For more information about student computer recommendations, please visit <https://hub.ncat.edu/administration/its/computer-recommendations.php>.

Classroom Citizenship

Courtesy, civility, and respect must be the hallmark of your interactions. It is expected that students will conduct themselves in a courteous manner to fellow students and the instructor.

Cell Phone Usage

Cell phone use inside classrooms during class periods is prohibited. Be advised that placing or receiving calls, as well as conversing on cell phones during class, shall be considered as disruptive behavior for students and may be subject to the procedures on Disruptive Students in the Classroom.

Compliance with the Americans with Disabilities Act

North Carolina A&T State University (N.C. A&T) is committed to following the requirements of the Americans with Disabilities Act Amendments Act (ADAAA) and Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act. Suppose you need an academic accommodation based on the impact of a disability. In that case, you must initiate the request with the Office of Accessibility Resources (OARS) and provide documentation in accordance with the Documentation Guidelines at N.C. A&T. Once documentation is received, it will be reviewed. Once approved, you must attend a comprehensive meeting to receive appropriate and reasonable accommodations. If you are a student registered with OARS, you must complete the Accommodation Request Form to have accommodations sent to faculty.

OARS is located in the Academic Classroom Building, Room 302 and can be reached at 336-334-7765, or by email at accessibilityresources@ncat.edu. Additional information and forms can be found on the internet at <https://www.ncat.edu/provost/academic-affairs/accessibility-resources/index.php>.

Please note: Accommodations are not retroactive and begin once the Disability Verification Form is provided to faculty.

Title IX

North Carolina A&T State University is committed to providing a safe learning environment for all students—free of all forms of discrimination and harassment. Sexual misconduct and relationship violence in any form are inconsistent with the university's mission and core values, violate university policies, and may also violate federal and state law. Faculty members are considered "Responsible Employees" and are required to report incidents of sexual misconduct and relationship violence to the Title IX Coordinator. If you or someone you know has been impacted by sexual harassment, sexual assault, dating or domestic violence, or stalking, please visit the Title IX website to access information about university support and resources <https://www.ncat.edu/legal/title-ix/index.php>. If you would like to

speak with someone confidentially, please contact the Counseling Services at 336-334-7727 or the Student Health Center at 336-334-7880.

Technical Requirements

Students are to refer to the Information Technology (IT) Services student computer requirement list to determine the minimum technical requirements based on College specifications. Link:

<https://hub.ncat.edu/administration/its/computer-recommendations.php>

Online Orientation Requirement

All new students at North Carolina Agricultural and Technical State University are required to complete an online orientation, which includes familiarizing themselves with the LMS tools (Canvas) and online learning strategies before starting their first course.

<https://bit.ly/AggieOnlineLearningOrientation>

How to Enroll

<https://bit.ly/AggieOnlineLearningOrientationSelfEnroll>

Technical Support

If you experience any problems with your N.C. A&T account, you may call Client Technology Services (formerly Aggie Tech Support and Help Desk) at 336-334-7195, or visit

<https://hub.ncat.edu/administration/its/dept/ats/index.php>

Field Trip Policies / Off-Campus Instruction and Course Activities

Off-campus, out-of-state, and foreign instruction and activities are subject to state law and university policies and procedures regarding travel and risk-related activities. Information regarding these rules and regulations may be found at <https://www.ncat.edu/campus-life/student-affairs/index.php>

Student Handbook

<https://www.ncat.edu/campus-life/student-affairs/departments/dean-of-students/student-handbook.php>

Undergraduate Catalog

<https://catalog.ncat.edu/>

Student Travel Procedures and Student Travel Activity Waiver

https://hub.ncat.edu/administration/student-affairs/staff-resources/student_activity_travel_waiver.pdf

Sexual Misconduct Policy (Title IX website)

<https://www.ncat.edu/legal/title-ix/policies.php>

Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA)

<https://www.ncat.edu/registrar/ferpa.php>

Grade Appeal

<https://catalog.ncat.edu/content.php?catoid=16&navoid=616#grade-appeal>

Student Complaint Policy

<https://hub.ncat.edu/administration/legal/policies/sec2-acad-affairs/student-complaint-policy-final.pdf>

Student Complaint Procedures

<https://www.ncat.edu/current-students/student-complaint-form.php>

Student Conduct and Discipline

North Carolina A&T State University has rules and regulations that govern student conduct and discipline meant to ensure the orderly and efficient

conduct of the educational enterprise. It is the responsibility of each student to be knowledgeable about these rules and regulations.

Please consult the following about specific policies such as academic dishonesty, cell phones, change of grade, disability services, disruptive behavior, general class attendance, grade appeal, incomplete grades, make-up work, student grievance procedures, withdrawal, etc.:

- Undergraduate Bulletin
<https://www.ncat.edu/provost/academic-affairs/bulletins/index.php>
- Graduate Catalog
<https://www.ncat.edu/tgc/graduate-catalog/index.php>
- Student Handbook
<https://www.ncat.edu/campus-life/student-affairs/departments/dean-of-students/student-handbook.php>

Academic Dishonesty Policy

Academic dishonesty includes but is not limited to the following:

1. Cheating or knowingly assisting another student in committing an act of cheating or other academic dishonesty;
2. Plagiarism (unauthorized use of another's words or ideas as one's own), which includes but is not limited to submitting exams, theses, reports, drawings, laboratory notes or other materials as one's own work when such work has been prepared by or copied from another person;
3. Unauthorized possession of exams or reserved library materials; destroying or hiding source, library or laboratory materials or experiments or any other similar actions;
4. Unauthorized changing of grades, or marking on an exam or in an instructor's grade book or such change of any grade record;
5. Aiding or abetting in the infraction of any of the provisions anticipated under the general standards of student conduct;

6. Hacking into a computer and gaining access to a test or answer key prior to the test being given. N.C. A&T reserves the right to search the emails and computers of any student suspected of such computer hacking if a police report of the suspected hacking was submitted prior to the search; and
7. Assisting another student in violating any of the above rules.

A student who has committed an act of academic dishonesty has failed to meet a basic requirement of satisfactory academic performance. Thus, academic dishonesty is not only a basis for disciplinary action but may also affect the evaluation of a student's level of performance. Any student who commits an act of academic dishonesty is subject to disciplinary action.

In instances where a student has clearly been identified as having committed an act of academic dishonesty, an instructor may take appropriate disciplinary action, including a loss of credit for an assignment, exam, or project; or awarding a grade of "F" for the course, **subject to review and endorsement by the chairperson and dean.**

The Office of Accessibility Resources

The Office of Accessibility Resources (OARS) works collaboratively with students, faculty, and staff to create a universally accessible campus where programs and services are usable by all people, to the greatest extent possible. OARS provides the campus community with resources and services for individuals with disabilities to achieve social justice and equity. New and returning students who request accommodations due to a disability or medical condition are responsible for registering with OARS, submitting documentation, knowing and following the policies and procedures of OARS located on our [Get Connected](#) webpage. OARS is located in the Academic Classroom Building, Room 302.

Phone: 336-334-7765

Email: accessibilityresources@ncat.edu

Office of Veteran & Military Affairs

The Office of Veteran and Military Affairs (OVMA) is here to meet the needs of our students who are veterans, service members, dependents of service members, and/or veterans. The OVMA certifies your educational benefits throughout each academic year. The OVMA is also prepared to advise and counsel you in regard to any veteran or education-related concerns. The OVMA serves as the liaison between veteran

students and the Department of Veterans Affairs. It assists eligible veteran students in understanding their educational benefits, provide guidance on procedural requirements, and certify, register, and report enrollments to the VA to ensure veterans receive their benefits in a timely manner.

The OVMA is located in The Aggie Student V.E.T.S. Center at The Oaks.
Phone: 336-398-8651

Counseling Services

Counseling Services, an [International Accreditation of Counseling Services](#) (IACS) accredited unit in the [Division of Student Affairs](#), offers a variety of services to help all currently enrolled North Carolina A&T students address challenges and difficulties they may face. Services are designed to help students understand themselves better, create and maintain healthy relationships, improve their academic performance, and make satisfying career and life choices. If you are experiencing distress, they provide a safe and confidential environment for counseling. You may contact Counseling Services at 336-334-7727 or stop by our office in Murphy Hall, Suite 109.

Tutorial Services

The mission of CAE Tutorial Program is to empower students for academic success within a safe and inclusive learning environment. Our goal is to provide academic support by offering a broad range of tutoring services for those students desiring to improve their in-class performance. When you schedule a tutoring session, you can get help with preparing for an upcoming exam or with covering difficult concepts you want to master.

North Carolina A&T State University has partnered with Upswing to help students find, schedule, and book tutoring sessions both in-person and virtually. Through a web-based tutoring platform, you can schedule FREE tutoring lessons with Upswing's online tutors, or with North Carolina A&T State University in-person tutors, for a variety of subjects. Go to ncat.upswing.io and log in with your Aggie OneID credentials to get started, or contact the Center for Academic Excellence at 336-334-7855.

Technology Support

Client Technology Services

Client Technology Services (CTS) is a part of Information Technology Services (ITS). This unit is responsible for desktop computing support and related software programs for the university. Support is provided in the academic labs, residential labs, and

administrative offices.

Phone: 336-334-7195

Email: helpdesk@ncat.edu

Canvas Log-In

<https://ncat.instructure.com/login/saml>

Log-in using your OneID credentials

For assistance with OneID accounts, contact Client Technology Services at 336-334-7195.

Academic Engagement

This course engages a range of scholarly perspectives to foster critical thinking, analysis, and debate. Inclusion of a reading does not imply endorsement of its views.

Useful Links

AGGIES CARE: N.C. A&T Protocols	https://www.ncat.edu/coronavirus/aggies-care/index.php
Student Computer Recommendations	https://hub.ncat.edu/administration/its/computer-recommendations.php
Accessibility Resource Email	https://www.ncat.edu/provost/academic-affairs/accessibility-resources/index.php
Office of Accessibility Resources	https://www.ncat.edu/provost/academic-affairs/accessibility-resources/index.php

Title IX	https://www.ncat.edu/legal/title-ix/index.php
Client Technology Services	https://hub.ncat.edu/administration/its/dept/ats/index.php
Division of Student Affairs	https://www.ncat.edu/campus-life/student-affairs/index.php
Student Handbooks	https://www.ncat.edu/campus-life/student-affairs/departments/dean-of-students/student-handbook.php
Graduate Catalog	https://www.ncat.edu/tgc/graduate-catalog/index.php
Student Activity Travel Waiver	https://hub.ncat.edu/administration/student-affairs/staff-resources/studen_activity_travel_waiver.pdf
Title IX Policies	https://www.ncat.edu/legal/title-ix/policies.php
FERPA	https://www.ncat.edu/registrar/ferpa.php

Student Complaint Procedure	https://www.ncat.edu/current-students/student-complaint-form.php
Undergraduate Bulletins	https://www.ncat.edu/provost/academic-affairs/bulletins/index.php